

Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY



Active Zones of Fake Money Network in India

1. Border districts of Rajasthan, like Barmer and Jaisalmer
2. Coastal areas of Kutch, Gujarat
3. Mangalore/Bangalore belt in Karnataka
4. Northern districts of Kerala
5. Colombo-Chennai transit route
6. Bangladesh border near Malda in West Bengal
7. Terai region of Uttar Pradesh and Bihar
8. Kashmir

Bangkok

Fake currency is sent here to be smuggled into India using Dawood Ibrahim's/Chhota Shakeel's underworld network.

Source of fake currency to major collection points

Major collection points to secondary collection points

By Malini Bhupta

Bhuvanesh Pandya, a small sweetshop owner in Mumbai's distant suburb of Mira Road, has just invested in a currency detection machine after his business was hit by a barrage of fake notes. With his local bank impounding the fake currency notes each time, Pandya decided to buy a currency detector, normally used by banks and treasuries. As the economy gets flooded with fakes, these machines are the only saving grace for small businesses like petrol pumps and local corner shops across the country as India reels under the onslaught of fake Indian currency notes (FICN). The average citizen is the worst-hit as fake banknotes have become so deeply embedded in the Indian economy that even bank branches and ATMs are disbursing counterfeit currency. From petrol stations to the local vegetable vendor, everybody is wary of accepting banknotes in denominations of Rs 500 and Rs 1,000 as a majority of the FICN are almost impossible to tell from genuine banknotes.

Fake notes are not a new phenomenon; what is new is the technological sophistication involved, the sharp rise in the amount of counterfeit currency—one

Singapore

A fake currency network is believed to be active.

THREAT

economy is fake, smuggled into India by Pakistan's ISI. How serious is the new terrorism?